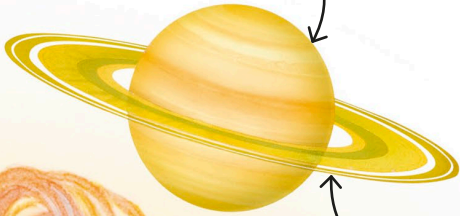


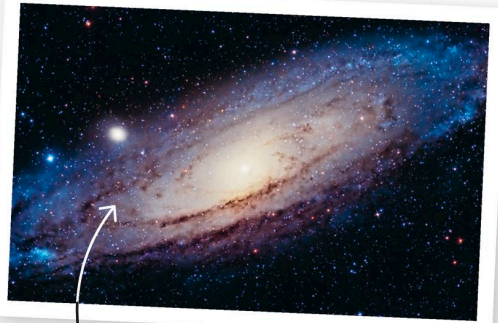
Bang!

Everything we know about exists in the Universe. It began about 14 billion years ago with a huge explosion called the Big Bang. The explosion pushed the young Universe apart. Over millions of years, the matter and energy that was produced from the explosion formed the galaxies, the stars, the planets, and eventually the human race.

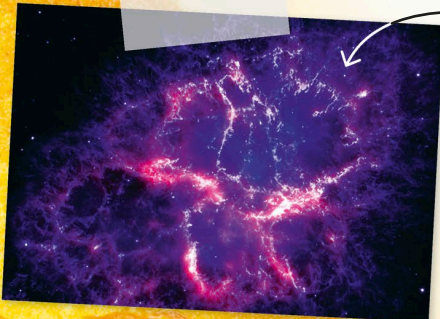
There are seven other main planets besides Earth. You can see some of them in the night sky—they often look like bright stars.



Some planets have rings around them.



Millions of stars live together in galaxies. They look like hazy patches of light.



A nebula is a cloud of gas and dust. Stars are being born in this nebula.

Nebulae are so far away that they too look like hazy patches of light in the sky.